

Northstar Technologies — Travel & Expense Policy

Version 1.0 | Fictional knowledge-base document for the Agentic RAG assignment

1. Business Travel

Travel Approval

Business travel must be approved by the employee's manager before bookings are made. Travel that exceeds the team's approved budget may require additional approval from the relevant department head.

Employees should select reasonable and cost-effective travel options while considering safety, customer commitments, and total travel time.

Booking

Flights and hotels should normally be booked through the company's approved travel process. Employees should not make unusually expensive bookings without obtaining the required approval.

2. Flights and Transportation

Air Travel

Domestic air travel may be booked in economy class. International travel may use economy or premium economy depending on flight duration and the company's applicable travel authorization.

Business-class travel requires prior written approval from the relevant department head.

Local Transportation

Reasonable taxi, rideshare, airport-transfer, and public-transport costs incurred for approved business travel are reimbursable when supported by appropriate receipts or electronic records.

3. Hotel Expenses

Accommodation Limit

For domestic business travel, the standard hotel reimbursement limit is INR 6,000 per night, excluding applicable taxes. A higher amount may be approved when reasonable accommodation within the limit is unavailable or when business circumstances require it.

For international travel, accommodation limits vary by destination and are communicated by Finance before the trip.

Hotel Selection

Employees should choose safe, reasonably located hotels that meet business requirements without unnecessary premium services. Personal upgrades are not reimbursable unless specifically approved.

4. Meals and Daily Allowance

Meal Reimbursement

During approved domestic business travel, employees may claim reasonable meal expenses up to INR 1,000 per travel day, including applicable taxes. Alcoholic beverages are not reimbursable.

Meal claims should include receipts where available and should identify the business travel dates.

Client Meals

Meals with customers or business partners may be reimbursed when they have a legitimate business purpose and prior approval is obtained when required by the team's expense policy.

5. Expense Submission

Submission Deadline

Employees must submit business-travel expense claims within 10 calendar days after returning from the trip. Claims submitted after the deadline may require additional manager or Finance approval.

Required Evidence

Expense claims should include the date, amount, category, business purpose, and supporting receipt or electronic record where available. Missing documentation may delay reimbursement.

6. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

Personal Costs

Personal entertainment, minibar purchases, spa services, personal shopping, traffic fines, and costs incurred by accompanying family members are not reimbursable.

Expenses that are unrelated to approved business activity or that violate company policy may be rejected.

7. Reimbursement Process

Manager Review

The employee's manager reviews the claim for business relevance and budget compliance. Finance performs the final processing according to the company's reimbursement procedures.

Payment

Approved reimbursements are normally paid through the employee's registered payroll or bank-payment method in the next available reimbursement cycle.